INDIAN FOREST SERVICE BENEVOLENT AND WELFARE TRUST

Standing for Green Warriors

GOVERNING BODY

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Shri A. K. Goyal

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Shri Sanjeev Chadha

REGISTERED OFFICE

Office of the Deputy Conservator of Forests,
Department of Forests and Wildlife,
Kamla Nehru Ridge,
New Delhi- 110007

File No. IFSBWT/101/2026/13-CM (UTT) Date: November 04 , 2026

To
Shri Pushkar Singh Dhami,
The Hon'ble Chief Minister,
Government of Uttarakhand,
Dehradun, Uttarakhand.
Email: cm-ua@nic.in

Subject: Formulation of a comprehensive institutionalised welfare policy for ex-gratia compensation and compassionate appointments for frontline forest personnel

Respected Sir,

The Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust (IFSBWT) respectfully submits this representation for your kind consideration.

2. The IFSBWT is a charitable trust registered with the Sub-Registrar-I, New Delhi, under the Registration Act, 1908. Managed by senior forestry professionals from the Indian Forest Service, it functions as a nationwide safety net, providing immediate supplementary financial assistance to frontline forestry personnel who are critically injured or to the families of those who die in harness in the line of duty.

3. Uttarakhand's forest landscape is both ecologically vital and operationally challenging. Managing over 38,000 square kilometres of forest territory, the State Forest Department protects critical wildlife habitats, including Corbett National Park, Rajaji National Park and the UNESCO World Heritage Site at the Valley of Flowers. As a primary source of regional hydrological security, this terrain encompasses the Gangotri and Yamunotri glacial origins of the Ganga and Yamuna rivers, surrounded by extensive deodar tracts in the higher ranges. Guarding these diverse ecosystems across varying altitudes, frontline personnel act as custodians of key wildlife species, ranging from the Royal Bengal tiger, Asian elephant and snow leopard in the terrestrial zones to the *gharial* and smooth-coated otter in the Ramganga and Ganga river systems.

4. In safeguarding these habitats, forestry personnel, particularly the frontline staff, operate under high-risk conditions, routinely combating severe

human-wildlife conflicts, navigating inaccessible alpine terrain, suppressing dangerous forest fires and confronting armed timber and sand-mining mafias. The gravity of these field risks is evident in the tragic losses suffered across various cadres. Foresters, forest guards, forest watchers, daily-wage workers and anti-poaching units continuously risk their lives, facing fatal wildlife encounters, perilous firefighting conditions and violent ambushes by illegal operators during-patrolling duties.

5. The public domain records underscore this grim reality through several tragic occurrences in recent years. The following reported incidents illustrate the sheer diversity of risks faced by our frontline forestry personnel in the line of duty:

- June 2026 (Thadung Beat, Tons Forest Division, Purola): Forest Beat Officer Sohan Singh Rawat lost his life after slipping from a precarious hill path and falling into a 100-metre-deep gorge while returning from duty after successfully dousing a severe forest fire.
- September 2025 (Kainchi Dham area, Nainital Forest Division): A dedicated Forest Daroga (Forester) Devendra Singh tragically lost his life after drowning in a flash-flood drain that rose rapidly due to heavy rainfall and cloudbursts while monitoring structural damage and clearing blocked forest routes.
- June 13, 2024 (Binsar Wildlife Sanctuary, Civil Soyam Forest Division, Almora): In a harrowing incident, four forest department personnel—Forest Beat Officer Trilok Singh Mehta, Fire Watcher Karan Arya, PRD Jawan Puran Singh, and Daily-wager Diwan Ram—were charred to death and four others were grievously injured when their team was suddenly engulfed by a raging wildfire during firefighting operations.
- May 2024 (Badrinath Forest Division, Chamoli): Rajendra Singh, a 45-year-old temporary fire watcher, suffered a fatal fall into a 100-foot-deep gorge while bravely combating a severe blaze in the steep pine forests near Chamoli range.
- October 2023 (Paterpani area, Kalagarh Range, Corbett Tiger Reserve): Forest Guard Pawan Kumar made the supreme sacrifice when he was suddenly ambushed and reportedly killed by a tiger while undertaking a routine anti-poaching foot patrol in the core area of the reserve.
- June 2019 (Berhaini Range, Terai Central Forest Division, Kumaon): Forest Guard Bahadur Singh Chauhan was shot dead by timber smugglers after he tried to stop them from cutting down trees in the Berhaini range.
- March 2017 (Kosi riverbed, Kaladhungi, Kumaon-Ramnagar border): Beat Watcher Pehalwan Singh was brutally crushed under a tractor by

illegal sand miners while attempting to stop illicit sand excavation in the Kosi riverbed. In separate incidents in the Kumaon timber belts, frontline guards like Bahadur Singh have laid down their lives under direct fire from armed timber smugglers.

6. The Trust notes that while the State Government has historically extended support to the families of deceased personnel through various ad hoc interventions, there is an urgent need for an institutionalised, uniform policy rather than reliance on case-by-case relief. This request draws a direct parallel to the institutionalised welfare mechanism that the Government of Uttarakhand has in place for its police and security forces, ensuring that families of personnel killed in the line of duty are not left vulnerable to severe financial hardships.

7. The policy should extend protection to personnel performing frontline duties regardless of cadre or mode of engagement, including regular, temporary, contractual, daily-wage and outsourced workers. The Trust recommends the complete removal of structural discrimination based on employment status when deciding on ex-gratia cases. In Uttarakhand, local and mountain-dwelling youths form the frontline backbone of the Forest Department, particularly within anti-poaching units, forest fire protection squads and anti-depredation teams. When a casual or outsourced worker is killed under the operational command of the Department, the emotional and financial devastation suffered by their family is identical to that of a permanent employee.

8. Therefore, to boost the morale of the State's forest force, the Trust respectfully requests the formulation of a comprehensive Uttarakhand Forest Force Welfare Policy with the following measures:

(i) A standardised, uniform, duty-linked ex-gratia payment in the range of ₹25 lakh to ₹50 lakh for fatalities in the line of duty, applicable across all ranks, explicitly including temporary, contractual, daily-wage and outsourced tracking or fire-watching staff, with appropriate provisions for serious injury or permanent disability, covering all eligible forestry personnel across all employment categories. In this regard, the welfare notifications of Maharashtra and Telangana are enclosed for reference at Annexures I and II, respectively.

(ii) A fast-tracked, time-bound framework for compassionate employment for the next of kin of permanent employees, and preferential skill training or institutional employment avenues for family members of deceased outsourced or daily-wage staff. Where compassionate appointment is not feasible, a

comprehensive financial-support package should be considered, including continued salary payments up to the date on which the deceased employee would ordinarily have retired, consideration for promotion to the next non-senior grade during the notional service period, and admissible pensionary benefits thereafter.

9. By translating compassionate precedents into an institutionalised, legally backed welfare framework for all forestry field personnel, Uttarakhand can establish itself as a national leader in safeguarding its "Green Warriors". The Trust, therefore, earnestly requests your good-self to favourably consider this vital structural reform and remains confident that it will find successful realisation under your leadership. The Trust's own assistance is supplementary to Government benefits. A brief note setting out its background, mandate, assistance provided and activities is enclosed for reference.

Yours sincerely,



(A. K. Goyal)
President
Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust
9910647881

Enclosures:

1. Annexure-I: Maharashtra Government Resolution dated 12 October 2022, original Marathi version (3 pages) and English translation of the Maharashtra Government Resolution dated 12 October 2022 (3 pages).
2. Annexure-II: Telangana Government G.O.Ms.No.43 dated 3 April 2023 (2 pages).
3. Annexure-III: A Note on the Trust, October 30, 2026 (4 pages)

वन विभागांतर्गत कार्यरत असलेल्या अधिकारी/ कर्मचारी यांचा वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू झाल्यास व कायमचे अपंगत्व आल्यास त्यांचे वारसास लाभ देण्याबाबत.

Annexure-I

महाराष्ट्र शासन

महसूल व वन विभाग

शासन निर्णय क्र. एफएसटी-११/२१/प्र. क्र.२४८/ फ-४

हुतात्मा राजगुरु चौक, मादाम कामा रोड,
मंत्रालय, मुंबई-४०० ०३२.
दिनांक: १२ ऑक्टोंबर, २०२२.

संदर्भ: १) महसूल व वन विभाग, शासन निर्णय क्र.टिआरएस-१०९८/प्रक्र.१९०/फ-६, दि.२२.९.२००८
२) अपर प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (प्रशासन व दुय्यम संवर्ग), नागपूर यांचे पत्र क्र.कक्ष- १०(२)/ आस्था/एक/प्रक्र.४६ (१७-१८)/१०८, दि.९.९.२०२०

प्रस्तावना:

राज्यात दि.२२.९.२००८ च्या शासन निर्णयान्वये वन धोरण करण्यात आलेले आहे. सदर वन धोरणात नैसर्गिक व मानव निर्मित वनांचे संरक्षण आणि व्यवस्थापन या अंतर्गत वनसंरक्षणाचे कर्तव्य पार पाडतांना कोणत्याही वन अधिकारी /कर्मचारी यांचा मृत्यू झाल्यास अथवा अपंग झाल्यास अशा बाधीत वन अधिकारी/ कर्मचारी यांना किंवा त्यांच्या नातेवाईकांना पोलीस खात्यात चालू असलेल्या पध्दतीप्रमाणे नुकसान भरपाई व आर्थिक मदत दिली जाईल असे ठरविण्यात आले आहे.

मानवाला तसेच पशु पक्षांना अनेक प्रकारे उपयोगी ठरणाऱ्या वनाचे संरक्षण करणे अत्यंत आवश्यक आहे. वनसंरक्षणाचे कर्तव्य पार पाडत असतांना वन अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांचे काही वेळा प्राण जातात अथवा गंभीररित्या जखमी होतात. या सर्व बाबी विचारात घेता, वन विभागांतर्गत कार्यरत असलेल्या अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांचा वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू झाल्यास व कायमचे अपंग झाल्यास अशा कर्मचाऱ्यांच्या कुटुंबियांना वा बाधित वन अधिकारी/कर्मचारी यांना महाराष्ट्र राज्यातील पोलीस विभागाच्या तसेच इतर राज्यात देण्यात येणाऱ्या नुकसान भरपाईच्या धर्तीवर नुकसान भरपाई तसेच इतर सोयी सुविधा देण्याची बाब शासनाच्या विचाराधीन होती.

शासन निर्णय:

वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर/ शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करताना मृत्यू पावलेल्या / कायमचे अपंगत्व आलेल्या अधिकारी/कर्मचाऱ्यांच्या वारसांना खालीलप्रमाणे नुकसान भरपाई तसेच इतर सोयी सुविधा मंजूर करण्यात येत आहेत.

(१) नुकसान भरपाई :-

अ. क्र.	पदनाम / श्रेणी	मृत्यू पावल्यास	कायमचे अपंगत्व आल्यास
१	गट-अ व त्यावरील अधिकारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,६०,०००/-
२	गट- ब अधिकारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,३०,०००/-
३	गट- क कर्मचारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,००,०००/-
४	गट- ड कर्मचारी	रु.२५,००,०००/-	रु.३,००,०००/-

वरीलप्रमाणे रु.२५ लक्ष नुकसान भरपाई ही कायदेशीर वारसदारांच्या संयुक्त नावाने मुदत ठेव म्हणून देण्यात येईल. सदर रक्कम १० वर्षांपर्यंत काढता येणार नाही. व्याज रक्कम दर महिन्याला घेता येईल. मुदत ठेवीची रक्कम फक्त अपवादात्मक परिस्थितीत व तसे नियुक्ती प्राधिकाऱ्याने प्रमाणित केल्यास ५ वर्षानंतर काढून घेता येईल.

(२) वन वणवा, वन्यप्राणी हल्ला, वन तस्कर / शिकारी यांच्या हल्ल्यात तसेच वन्य प्राण्यांचा बचाव करतांना मृत्यू पावलेल्या वन अधिकारी /कर्मचाऱ्याच्या कुटुंबात अनुकंपा नियुक्तीस पात्र उमेदवार नसल्यास अगर वारसाने अनुकंपा नियुक्ती स्विकारण्यास नकार दिल्यास, मृत अधिकारी /कर्मचारी जणू काही मृत झाली नाही असे मानून सदर अधिकारी /कर्मचारी सेवेत असते तर मृत्यूच्यावेळी जे पद धारण करीत होते त्या पदावरुन वरच्या पदावर पदोन्नतीसाठी ज्या ज्या वेळी पात्र ठरली असती त्या-त्या वेळी सदर व्यक्ती पदोन्नत झाली असे गृहीत धरुन त्या अधिकारी/कर्मचाऱ्याची वेतन निश्चिती करण्यात यावी. त्यानुसार पदोन्नतीच्या पदावर निश्चित करण्यात आलेले वेतन मृत वन अधिकारी /कर्मचाऱ्याच्या नियत वयोमानानुसार सेवानिवृत्तीच्या दिनांकापर्यंत देण्यात यावे. सदर वेतन वार्षिक वेतनवाढीसह देण्यात यावे.

(३) मृत्यूमुखी पडलेल्या वन अधिकारी / कर्मचारी यांचे पार्थिव देह रेल्वे, बस व ॲम्बुलन्स इत्यादी प्रकारच्या वाहनाद्वारे नेण्याचा सर्व खर्च व पार्थिव देहाबरोबर एका व्यक्तिला जाण्यासाठी येणारा खर्च शासनातर्फे करण्यात यावा.

(४) जखमी वन अधिकारी / कर्मचारी यांचा राज्यांतर्गत औषधोपचारांचा व शस्त्रक्रियेचा रुग्णालयातील सर्व खर्च राज्य शासनातर्फे देण्यात यावा.

हा शासन निर्णय निर्गमित केल्याच्या दिनांकापासून अंमलात येईल.

२. सदर शासन निर्णय महाराष्ट्र शासनाच्या www.maharashtra.gov.in या संकेतस्थळावर उपलब्ध करण्यात आला असून त्याचा संकेतांक २०२२१०१२११२८१००३१९ असा आहे. हा आदेश डिजीटल स्वाक्षरीने साक्षांकित करून काढण्यात येत आहे.

महाराष्ट्राचे राज्यपाल यांच्या आदेशानुसार व नावाने,

RAVIKIRAN SABAJI GOVEKAR

Digitally signed by RAVIKIRAN SABAJI GOVEKAR
DN: c=IN, o=GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA, ou=REVENUE AND FOREST DEPARTMENT, 2.5.4.20=b00b3ae6f82b447bdd60190209f1258e170f8f617d261f81e6281dfbfdf28c0d, postalCode=400032, st=Maharashtra, serialNumber=B752370B557D0A3E58B4B069230BC54F6A13D04798D2EE7A3F1C7DCC5655271C, cn=RAVIKIRAN SABAJI GOVEKAR
Date: 2022.10.12 11:30:28 +05'30'

(डॉ. रविकिरण गोवेकर)
मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (मंत्रालय)

प्रत,

१. मा. राज्यपाल यांचे सचिव, राजभवन, मलबार हिल, मुंबई,
२. मा. मुख्यमंत्री यांचे प्रधान सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
३. मा. उपमुख्यमंत्री यांचे प्रधान सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
४. मा. मंत्री (वने) यांचे खाजगी सचिव, मंत्रालय ,मुंबई,
५. सर्व मा.मंत्री यांचे खाजगी सचिव, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
६. मा. विरोधी पक्ष नेता, विधान परिषद/ विधान सभा, महाराष्ट्र विधानमंडळ सचिवालय, मुंबई,
७. मा. मुख्य सचिव यांचे वरिष्ठ स्वीय सहाय्यक, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,
८. सर्व मंत्रालयीन विभाग, मंत्रालय, मुंबई,

९. सर्व मंत्रालयीन विभागाचे अमुस/प्र.स./सचिव,
१०. सचिव, मा. सभापती, विधानपरिषद, विधानमंडळ, मुंबई,
११. सचिव, मा. अध्यक्ष, विधानसभा, विधानमंडळ, मुंबई,
१२. महालेखापाल -१ व २ (लेखा व अनुज्ञेयता)/(लेखापरीक्षा), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, मुबंई/नागपूर
१३. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (वनबल प्रमुख), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, नागपूर
१४. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (वन्यजीव), महाराष्ट्र राज्य, नागपूर.
१५. प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक, सामाजिक वनीकरण, महाराष्ट्र राज्य, पुणे.
१६. अपर प्रधान मुख्य वनसंरक्षक, (सर्व)
१७. मुख्य वनसंरक्षक (सर्व)/वनसंरक्षक (सर्व) / उप वनसंरक्षक (सर्व) / विभागीय वन अधिकारी (सर्व)
१८. जिल्हा कोषागार अधिकारी (सर्व),
१९. निवडनस्ती, फ-४ कार्यासन महसूल व वन विभाग, मंत्रालय, मुंबई.

Subject: Regarding the grant of benefits to the heirs of officers/employees working under the Forest Department in the event of death or permanent disability caused by forest fire, wild animal attack, attack by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals.

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
Revenue and Forest Department
Government Resolution No. FST-11/21/Pra.Kra.248/F-4
Hutatma Rajguru Chowk, Madam Cama Road,
Mantralaya, Mumbai-400 032.
Date: October 12, 2022.

References:

1. Revenue and Forest Department, Government Resolution No. TRS-1098/Prakra.190/F-6, dated September 22, 2008
2. Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Administration and Subordinate Cadre), Nagpur, Letter No. Kaksha-10(2)/Astha/Ek/Prakra.46(17-18)/108, dated September 9, 2020

Preamble:

A forest policy was framed in the State vide the Government Resolution dated September 22, 2008. Under the said forest policy, it was decided that if any forest officer/employee dies or becomes disabled while discharging the duty of forest conservation under the protection and management of natural and man-made forests, such affected forest officer/employee, or their relatives, would be granted compensation and financial assistance as per the procedure prevailing in the Police Department.

It is extremely necessary to protect forests, which are useful to humans as well as to birds and animals in many ways. While discharging the duty of forest conservation, forest officers/employees sometimes lose their lives or are seriously injured. Taking all these matters into consideration, the question of providing compensation and other facilities — on the lines of the compensation given in the Police Department of the State of Maharashtra and in other States — to the families of such employees / affected forest officers/employees who die or become permanently disabled in forest fires, wild animal attacks, attacks by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals, was under the consideration of the Government.

Government Resolution:

Compensation and other facilities are hereby sanctioned as follows to the heirs of officers/employees who die or become permanently disabled in forest fires, wild animal attacks, attacks by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals.

(1) Compensation:

Sr. No.	Designation / Category	In case of death	In case of permanent disability
1	Group-A and above officers	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,60,000/-
2	Group-B officers	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,30,000/-
3	Group-C employees	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,00,000/-
4	Group-D employees	Rs. 25,00,000/-	Rs. 3,00,000/-

The compensation of Rs. 25 lakh as above shall be given as a fixed deposit in the joint name of the legal heirs. The said amount shall not be withdrawable for 10 years. The interest amount may be drawn every month. The fixed deposit amount may be withdrawn after 5 years only in exceptional circumstances and if so certified by the appointing authority.

(2) If there is no candidate eligible for compassionate appointment in the family of the forest officer/employee who died in a forest fire, wild animal attack, attack by forest smugglers/poachers, or while rescuing wild animals, or if the heir refuses to accept compassionate appointment, then — presuming as if the deceased officer/employee had not died — the pay of such officer/employee shall be fixed by assuming that, had the said officer/employee remained in service, the person would have been promoted on each occasion on which they would have become eligible for promotion to a higher post from the post held at the time of death. Accordingly, the pay fixed at the promotional post shall be paid up to the date of superannuation as per the prescribed retirement age of the deceased forest officer/employee. The said pay shall be given along with annual increments.

(3) The entire cost of transporting the mortal remains of the deceased forest officer/employee by means such as railway, bus, ambulance, etc., as well as the cost incurred for one person to travel along with the mortal remains, shall be borne by the Government.

(4) The entire cost of medical treatment and surgery within the State, in hospital, for injured forest officers/employees shall be borne by the State Government.

This Government Resolution shall come into effect from the date of its issue.

2. This Government Resolution has been made available on the Government of Maharashtra website www.maharashtra.gov.in, and its code is **202210121128100319**. This order is being issued with digital signature authentication.

By order and in the name of the Governor of Maharashtra,

(Dr. Ravikiran Govekar)

Chief Conservator of Forests (Mantralaya)

Copy to:

1. Secretary to the Hon. Governor, Rajbhavan, Malabar Hill, Mumbai
2. Principal Secretary to the Hon. Chief Minister, Mantralaya, Mumbai
3. Principal Secretary to the Hon. Deputy Chief Minister, Mantralaya, Mumbai
4. Private Secretary to the Hon. Minister (Forests), Mantralaya, Mumbai
5. Private Secretaries to all Hon. Ministers, Mantralaya, Mumbai
6. Hon. Leader of the Opposition, Legislative Council / Legislative Assembly, Maharashtra Legislature Secretariat, Mumbai
7. Senior Personal Assistant to the Hon. Chief Secretary, Mantralaya, Mumbai
8. All Mantralaya Departments, Mantralaya, Mumbai
9. Additional Chief Secretary / Principal Secretary / Secretary of all Mantralaya Departments
10. Secretary to the Hon. Chairman, Legislative Council, Legislature, Mumbai
11. Secretary to the Hon. Speaker, Legislative Assembly, Legislature, Mumbai
12. Accountant General -1 and 2 (Accounts and Entitlement) / (Audit), Maharashtra State, Mumbai/Nagpur
13. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Head of Forest Force), Maharashtra State, Nagpur
14. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (Wildlife), Maharashtra State, Nagpur
15. Principal Chief Conservator of Forests, Social Forestry, Maharashtra State, Pune
16. Additional Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (All)
17. Chief Conservator of Forests (All) / Conservator of Forests (All) / Deputy Conservator of Forests (All) / Divisional Forest Officer (All)
18. District Treasury Officer (All)
19. Select File, F-4 Section, Revenue and Forest Department, Mantralaya, Mumbai

1959148/2023/O/o PRINCIPAL CHIEF CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS TELANGANA

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA

ABSTRACT

Annexure- II

EFS&T Department – Ex-gratia to the Forest personnel who died by extremist /anti social elements while protecting forest – Sanction - Orders – Issued.

ENVIRONMENT, FOREST, SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY (FOR-II) DEPARTMENT

G.O.Ms.No.43 Dated:03.04.2023.

PCCF & HoFF
T.S. PESHI
04 APR 2023

Read:-

From the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (HoFF), Telangana State, Hyderabad, File No.506955(II)/2022/VIG-2, Dt:15.12.2022

***

PCCF (P&V(G))

ORDER:

In the reference read above, the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (HoFF), Telangana State, Hyderabad has informed that the Forest front line staff have to discharge their duties in the forests, mainly in rural areas in very difficult and cumbersome situations. At times the staff have to move alone in the interior of the forests to perambulate and protect the areas. In such situations, they are prone to attacks by anti-social elements as no immediate help is likely to be available. Therefore, the Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (HoFF), Telangana State, Hyderabad has requested for issue of orders extending the ex-gratia / other benefits to the forest personnel who died while protecting the forest on par with police officials.

2. After careful consideration, Government has decided to sanction the ex-gratia in respect of Forest personnel and their families who were killed by extremist /anti-social elements while protecting the forest.

3. Accordingly, Government hereby sanction the ex-gratia as mentioned hereunder:

Ex-Gratia			
Category	In case of death in extremist / anti-social elements	In case of permanent incapacitation in extremist / anti-social elements	In case of grievous hurt in extremist / anti-social elements
	Rs.in lakhs	Rs.in lakhs	Rs.in lakhs
Forest Beat Officer & equivalent ranks	30.00	20.00	3.00
Forest Section Officer & Deputy Range Officer & equivalent ranks	45.00	25.00	5.00
Forest Range Officers & equivalent ranks	50.00	30.00	5.00
Assistant Conservator of Forests, Deputy Conservator of Forests & equivalent ranks	75.00	40.00	5.00
All IFS officers	100.00	50.00	6.00

4. The Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (HoFF), Telangana State, Hyderabad and all Collectors and District Magistrates shall take necessary action accordingly.

5. This order issues with the concurrence of the Finance (DCM) Department, vide their U.O.Note No.1771/336/A2/DCM/2022, dt.24.12.2022.

(BY ORDER AND IN THE NAME OF THE GOVERNOR OF TELANGANA)

SANTHI KUMARI
CHIEF SECRETARY TO GOVERNMENT &
SPECIAL CHIEF SECRETARY TO GOVERNMENT (FORESTS)

To

The Principal Chief Conservator of Forests (HoFF), Telangana State, Hyderabad
All Collectors and District Magistrates
The Finance (DCM) Department
The Director of Treasuries and Accounts, Telangana, Hyderabad.
All District Treasury Officers.
The Pay and Accounts Officer, Telangana Hyderabad.

(P.T.O).

959148/2023/O/o PRINCIPAL CHIEF CONSERVATOR OF FORESTS TELANGANA

Copy to:

The P.S., to Minister (Forest &Environment, Science &Technology, Law & Endowment).
The P.S., to Chief Secretary to Government
The P.S., to Secretary to Chief Minister.
SC/SF

//FORWARDED :: BY ORDER//

SECTION OFFICER

INDIAN FOREST SERVICE BENEVOLENT AND WELFARE TRUST

Standing for Green Warriors

A NOTE ON THE TRUST

Background, Governance, Objects, Assistance, Institutional Development and Modes of Contribution

INTRODUCTION

Across India, Forest Watchers, Guards, Foresters, Range Officers, State Forest Service (SFS) and Indian Forest Service (IFS) officers serve in remote and inhospitable terrain. They face poachers, illegal miners, wildlife, forest fires and other hazards, often with limited backup.

Death or grievous injury in the line of duty can leave families in immediate financial distress. The Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust (IFSBWT) offers timely and dignified support, supplementary to assistance payable by the State or Union Territory (UT) administration.

BACKGROUND AND HISTORY

The Trust was established in July 2008 by a group of IFS officers in Delhi as a charitable trust under the Registration Act, 1908. Its original purpose was to assist the bereaved families of IFS officers who died in harness. The Trust Deed was registered as No. 3512, Book No. 4, for 2008–2009.

The Trust held meetings in 2008 and 2009, established its banking and governance arrangements and began building a corpus. It provided some financial support to three families of IFS officers who died in harness. Thereafter, largely because the officers who had built the institution were transferred and an enduring operating structure had not yet developed, the Trust became dormant. Its corpus nevertheless remained intact in the bank.

A series of incidents involving deaths and grievous injuries among frontline forestry personnel prompted the surviving Trustees to revive the Trust. At the Board of Trustees meeting held on January 24, 2026, the Trust was formally revived, its beneficiary scope was substantially widened, a new Governing Body was elected, eight new Trustees were inducted and two committees were constituted. The Amended Trust Deed was registered with the Sub-Registrar-I, Kashmere Gate (Central), New Delhi on February 11, 2026, thereby recording and giving effect to the revised mandate and governance structure.

LEGAL AND COMPLIANCE STATUS

Item	Current position
Registration	Amended Trust Deed registered on February 11, 2026; Registration No. 2026/19/IV/32. The Trust continues the charitable institution originally constituted in 2008.
Registered Office	Office of the Deputy Conservator of Forests, Department of Forests and Wildlife, Kamla Nehru Ridge, New Delhi-110007.
PAN	AACTI5925J.
NGO-DARPAN	Unique ID DL/2026/1100169; registration dated August 27, 2026.
Income-tax application	Form No. 105 was filed on May 27, 2026 for registration under s. 332 and approval under s. 354 of the Income-tax Act, 2025, for five years. Approval is pending; no tax deduction is claimed for donors until granted.
Audit and return	The accounts for FY 2025–26 have been audited and approved. The Income Tax Return in Form ITR-5 for Assessment Year 2026–27 was filed and verified on September 28, 2026.
Banking and digital collection	SBI account at CGO Complex, Lodi Road, New Delhi. UPI and SBI Collect on www.foresttrust.in are active, with automated donation acknowledgements.

ORGANISATION AND TEAM

The Trust is governed through a structure designed to combine policy oversight, operational management, objective scrutiny of assistance cases and State-level outreach.

I. Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees (BoT) is the apex policy-making body with overall control and management of the Trust. It has 32 Life Trustees drawn from serving and retired IFS officers. Office bearers of the Indian Forest Service Association (IFSA), Central Unit, are special invitees. All serving and retired IFS officers are deemed members of the Trust.

II. Governing Body

The Governing Body (GB) is responsible for day-to-day management, assistance decisions, records, finances and legal compliances.

Office	Name (Cadre : Batch)
President	Shri A. K. Goyal (KR : 1981)
Vice-President	Dr. D. D. Sharma (JHK : 1984)
Secretary	Shri R. K. Chaudhry (PB : 1987)
Treasurer	Shri V. K. Tiwari (HP : 1986)
Joint Secretary	Shri Sanjeev Chadha (OR : 1989)
Members	Shri Ashok Pai (UTT : 1983); Shri Surender Kumar (TR : 1985); Dr. Bipin Bihari (AGMUT : 1985); Shri Surendra Kumar (KR : 1986); Shri A. K. Johari (AM : 1986); Shri C. D. Singh (AGMUT : 1987); Ms. Jyotsna Sitling (UTT : 1987); Ms. Anita Karn (GJ : 1997); Shri Kunal Satyarthi (HP : 1997); Shri Nishant Verma (UTT : 1999).

III. Committees of the Governing Body

Coordination Committee. Liaises with State Forest Departments (SFDs), forestry associations and other bodies; creates awareness; identifies cases; supports reporting; and helps mobilise the corpus. Chairman: Shri V. K. Tiwari; Vice-Chairman: Shri Kunal Satyarthi; Secretary: Shri Sanjeev Chadha; Members: Shri C. D. Singh, Shri Ajay Kumar Lal, Shri Rajan Sehgal, Ms. Anita Karn, Shri Nishant Verma and Shri Deepak Mohanty.

Committee for Scrutiny and Evaluation of Proposals (CSEP). Scrutinises assistance proposals and recommends action to the GB. Chairman: Shri Ashok Pai; Vice-Chairman: Shri Surendra Kumar; Secretary: Shri Anil Ganeriwala; Members: Shri Surender Kumar, Shri A. K. Johari, Ms. Jyotsna Sitling, Shri V. B. Kumar, Shri Suneesh Buxy and Ms. Cheshta Singh.

IV. State/UT Network

The State/UT network has 16 Coordinators and 09 Nodal Officers to improve awareness, reporting and case processing. They liaise with SFDs and associations, report incidents, support proposals, mobilise voluntary contributions and compile State welfare orders.

OBJECTS AND PURPOSES OF THE TRUST

- To provide financial assistance to the bereaved families of IFS officers and all other forestry field personnel who die while performing their duties;
- To provide financial assistance in cases of serious injury, disability or critical illness arising in the course of performing duties; and
- To undertake any other activity for the welfare of the families of officers and other forestry field personnel, as may be decided by the Trustees from time to time.

ASSISTANCE FRAMEWORK

Trust assistance is supplementary to the statutory or other entitlements available to the family. The GB decides the quantum case by case on CSEP recommendations, considering the duty nexus, family circumstances and resources available.

Donor-directed assistance. Donors who wish to support a specific beneficiary family may route the contribution through the Trust. Such earmarked contributions are passed on to the identified family in full and are accounted for separately.

FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE PROVIDED SO FAR

As on October 30, 2026, the Trust has approved assistance of ₹24.85 lakh in 11 cases across ten States. Of this, ₹20.35 lakh has been released and ₹4.50 lakh remains payable in four cases, subject to availability of funds. Details follow:

1. **Late Shri Jitendra Singh Shekhawat, Forest Guard, Rajasthan:** Made the supreme sacrifice while combating illegal sand mining; ₹1.35 lakh released to the family.
2. **Late Shri Harikesh Singh Gurjar, Forest Guard, Madhya Pradesh:** Made the supreme sacrifice while on duty against illegal sand mining; ₹3.00 lakh released to the family.
3. **Thiru S. Radhakrishnan, Assistant Conservator of Forests, Tamil Nadu:** Grievously injured in the line of duty; ₹2.00 lakh released towards emergency treatment.
4. **Ms. Rasmita Subuddhi, Forest Guard, Odisha:** Grievously injured while returning from patrol duty; ₹2.50 lakh released towards emergency medical treatment.
5. **Late Shri Sohan Singh, Forest Guard, Uttarakhand:** Made the supreme sacrifice while battling a forest fire; ₹2.00 lakh released to his mother.
6. **Late Shri Hari Om, Forester, Haryana:** Died in a road accident while proceeding on official duty; ₹3.00 lakh released to the family.

7. **Late Shri Vikaskumar Nagjibhai Desai, Range Forest Officer, Gujarat:** Made the supreme sacrifice while intercepting the illegal transport of khair wood; ₹2.00 lakh released to the family.
8. **Late Shri Lakhan Singh Maravi, Fire Watcher, Madhya Pradesh:** Killed by a tiger while on patrol; ₹3.00 lakh approved, first instalment of ₹1.50 lakh released and ₹1.50 lakh pending.
9. **Late Shri Shyamu Mahagu Sharnagat, Forest Guard, Maharashtra:** Killed by a sloth bear while on patrol; ₹2.00 lakh approved, first instalment of ₹1.00 lakh released and ₹1.00 lakh pending.
10. **Late Shri B. Naveen, Forest Beat Officer, Telangana:** Electrocuted while attempting to apprehend poachers; ₹2.00 lakh approved, first instalment of ₹1.00 lakh released and ₹1.00 lakh pending.
11. **Late Shri Rajkumar Chakraborty, Head Forest Guard, Jharkhand:** Died in a road accident while returning home from duty; the incident was certified as a line-of-duty death. ₹2.00 lakh approved, of which ₹1.00 lakh was released to his spouse on October 12, 2026; ₹1.00 lakh remains payable to his mother.

PROCEDURE FOR SEEKING FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE

Cases may be reported by an SFD, State/UT Coordinator, Nodal Officer, forestry association or affected family. The proposal, ordinarily verified through the concerned SFD, may be submitted through the online form at www.foresttrust.in.

- Brief summary of the incident and circumstances of death or injury;
- Certification of the duty connection by the controlling officer;
- FIR or Police General Diary entry, where applicable;
- Particulars of financial assistance already received or due from other sources;
- Family composition, financial condition and employment status of dependants;
- Status of compassionate appointment, where applicable; and
- Bank account details of the proposed beneficiary.

After CSEP scrutiny, the GB determines the assistance. Approved amounts are transferred directly to the beneficiary's bank account.

INSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENT, OUTREACH AND COMMUNICATION

- Website www.foresttrust.in launched in March 2026; donor and beneficiary information, newsletters and key Trust material are published online. The Trust also uses email, WhatsApp and LinkedIn for outreach.
- Monthly e-Newsletters have been issued to provide a public record of assistance, governance decisions, outreach and corpus-building activities.

Nationwide outreach has included communications to Principal Chief Conservators of Forests (Heads of Forest Force) [PCCFs (HoFFs)], IFSA State/UT units and forestry associations; appeals to young IFS officers; and approaches to Central Public Sector Undertakings (CPSUs), foundations, the Federation of Indian Plywood & Panel Industry (FIPPI) and other forest-linked industries.

At the Trust's request, the Director General of Forests & Special Secretary, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC), wrote to PCCFs (HoFFs) of all States/UTs on April 17, 2026, encouraging support for the Trust.

Outreach included the May 23 webinar with forestry associations, the May 26 press conference, interactions with IFS probationers and in-service officers at Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy (IGNFA) on August 17, 2026, a briefing with the PCCF (HoFF), Odisha, on August 30, 2026, and a presentation at the 16th National Meet of State Biodiversity Boards (SBBs) and UT Biodiversity Councils (UTBCs) on September 6–7, 2026, with PCCF (HoFF),Assam on October 8, 2026, in offline mode, and online with PCCF (HoFF) of Punjab and Himachal Pradesh on October 15, 2026.

- The Trust has begun issuing condolence messages to bereaved families of deceased IFS officers and appreciation letters to officers making one-time contributions of ₹50,000 or more.

POLICY ADVOCACY FOR FORESTRY PERSONNEL

The Trust has also advocated improved State support for forestry personnel who die or suffer grievous injury in the line of duty. Its comparative study covers ten State instruments: dedicated forest-specific orders, general employee schemes, salary-account insurance arrangements and employee-funded mechanisms. Maharashtra, Telangana and Karnataka offer useful elements for adaptation.

The Trust has written to the Hon'ble Chief Ministers of Gujarat and West Bengal seeking stronger duty-linked welfare arrangements and to the Hon'ble Minister, MoEFCC, seeking wider policy and institutional support. State welfare/compensation orders collected by the Trust are being made available for reference and advocacy.

MODES OF CONTRIBUTION

The Trust welcomes voluntary contributions from individuals, institutions, corporations, associations, societies and other entities, subject to applicable law. Contributions may be made through the following modes:

Account Name	Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust
Account Number	**30454625682**
IFSC	SBIN0007837
Bank	State Bank of India
Branch	CGO Complex, Lodi Road, New Delhi-110003

UPI	ifsbwt@sbi
Online	SBI Collect on www.foresttrust.in (direct contribution with automated acknowledgement)  Scan to donate | UPI: ifsbwt@sbi

Acknowledgement of donations. Individual acknowledgements are issued for contributions. Contributions made through SBI Collect generate an automated acknowledgement. Donor information is periodically updated on the Trust website. The Trust also recognises one-time contributions of ₹50,000 or more through appreciation letters from the President.

Income-tax status. The application under sections 332 and 354 of the Income-tax Act, 2025 is pending. Until approval is granted, the Trust does not claim that donations are eligible for tax deduction.

CURRENT PRIORITIES

The Trust's immediate priorities are:

- strengthen the corpus so that sanctioned assistance, including pending instalments, can be released without delay;
- secure registration/approval under sections 332 and 354 of the Income-tax Act, 2025;
- extend the State Coordinator and Nodal Officer network to every State and Union Territory and improve immediate reporting of casualty cases;
- continue structured engagement with PCCFs (HoFFs), SFDs and forestry associations for awareness and voluntary participation;
- pursue duty-linked welfare and compensation mechanisms with State Governments, drawing on the comparative study of existing State models;
- examine practical insurance, education, medical and other welfare measures that may be taken up under the wider family-welfare object of the Trust; and
- strengthen the website, SBI Collect, e-Newsletters and other digital communication channels for transparency and easier participation.

CONTACT

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- Dr. D. D. Sharma, Vice-President — +91 98689 45506
- Shri R. K. Chaudhry, Secretary — +91 95309 03714
- Shri V. K. Tiwari, Treasurer — +91 94184 59606
- Shri Sanjeev Chadha, Joint Secretary — +91 98704 99744

Email: ifsbwtrust@gmail.com | Website: www.foresttrust.in

Dedicated to the welfare of all forestry field personnel and their families
(Frontline Field Staff, Forest Range Officers, State Forest Service Officers and Indian Forest Service Officers)